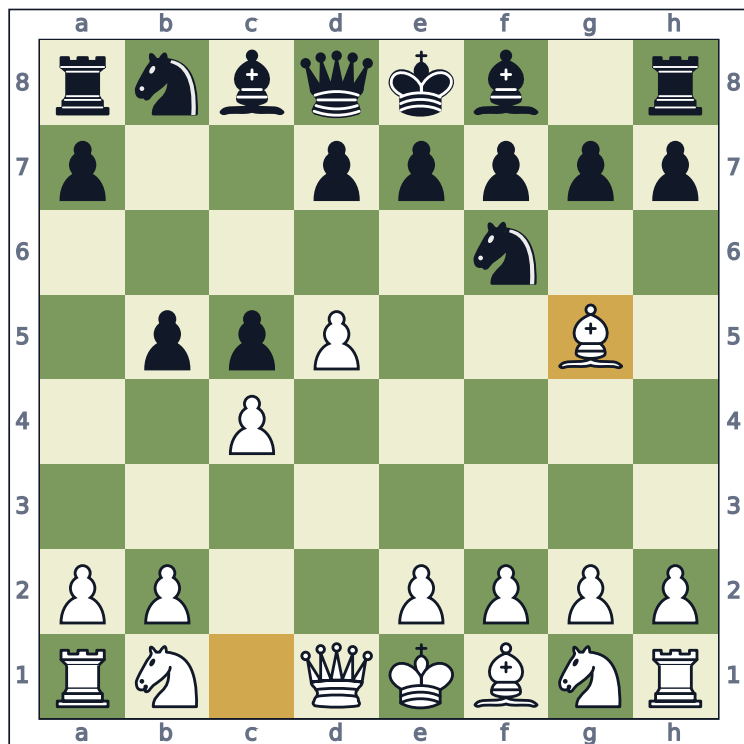


BENONI, BENKO, AND INDIAN STRUCTURES

Benko Gambit Declined

ECO A57 | 15 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.03 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A57 covers Benko Gambit Declined. The center becomes asymmetric: White often owns space, while Black seeks dynamic files, diagonals, and pawn breaks. The diagram uses the featured line Benko Gambit Declined: Bishop Attack.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. Bg5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, finish development, support e4, and prepare a central or queenside expansion without overextending.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the pawn center with ...e6, ...c5, or ...b5, activate the dark-squared bishop, and create counterplay before White consolidates.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White commonly uses e5 or b4; Black's thematic resources include ...e6, ...b5, and sometimes ...f5.

PIECE MAP

White's central pawns need piece support. Black's bishops and rooks become strong when files open on the queenside. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Space is valuable but can become a target. A premature pawn advance may leave weak squares behind it. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets. the word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Good for ambitious players: strategically rich and fully playable, but many lines require comfort with imbalance.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A57 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to A57 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Benko Gambit
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5

002 Benko Gambit Accepted
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6

003 Benko Gambit Accepted: Dlugy Variation
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. f3

004 Benko Gambit Accepted: Modern Variation
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. e3

005 Benko Gambit Accepted: Pawn Return Variation
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. b6

006 Benko Gambit Declined: Bishop Attack
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. Bg5

007 Benko Gambit Declined: Hjørring Countergambit
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. e4

008 Benko Gambit Declined: Main Line
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. Nf3

009 Benko Gambit Declined: Pseudo-Sämisch
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. f3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A57 line

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010 Benko Gambit Declined: Quiet Line

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. Nd2

011 Benko Gambit Declined: Sosonko Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. a4

012 Benko Gambit: Mutkin Countergambit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. g4

013 Benko Gambit: Nescafe Frappe Attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. Nc3 axb5 6. e4 b4 7. Nb5 d6 8. Bc4

014 Benko Gambit: Zaitsev System

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. Nc3

015 Benko Gambit: Zaitsev Variation, Nescafe Frappe Attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. Nc3 axb5 6. e4 b4 7. Nb5